TA brief · access, kit and safety

For up to five learners: two sets of toy/surface cards, two torches and marked balls or their picture models, two long-term climate-card sets, trays, and five record sheets with pencils. Five work as a pair plus trio; four as two pairs; three as a trio. Keep one record per learner.

Use familiar adult-checked kit. Keep small parts on trays, any toy run low and clear, and torch beams away from eyes. Launch only with permission. Prepared cards are a valid route. Confirm the local risk assessment and any formal-evidence conditions.

GROW: up to five learners. Use a pair and a trio for five, two pairs for four, a trio for three, or a pair for two. In a pair, one explains and one asks for the clue; swap. In a trio, the third checks the source, then rotate all roles. Each learner first chooses privately and keeps their own record. Hear every learner at the hinge. Re-model a shared error, or support an unsure learner while secure learners try a fresh check. Never use a percentage rule.

No cold calling or forced public reading. A learner may pass. Point, sign, speak, draw, type, write, direct an adult or use exact scribing. Read the task exactly when needed. Keep the science challenge and allow planning in any language. EAL is language, not SEN.

Use the least prompt needed, then fade it. Keep prompts separate from the pupil’s response.

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TA brief · prompt ladder and stage handover

1. Point to the relevant place / instruction.

2. Ask one short question: "What is it asking you to find?"

3. Rephrase the instruction in simpler language.

4. Provide a scaffold or limited choice.

5. Model the first step only, then return the task to the pupil.

Arrival: predictable start and private choice. Starter: hear first attempts before answers. I do: point to the model and let the learner track each step. We do: leave the missing step to the learner. Independent: protect an individual first try.

Review and Exit: the adult receives the learner’s own science, names it back and agrees a precise next move. Record the deepest prompt and what was independent. No physical prompting; pass and pause remain available.

Timing: Arrival 5 min, Starter 3 min, I do 5 min, We do 7 min, We do 2 5 min, Independent 8 min, Review 4 min, Exit 3 min. Total 40 minutes. Alternative route views share the same task time.

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